

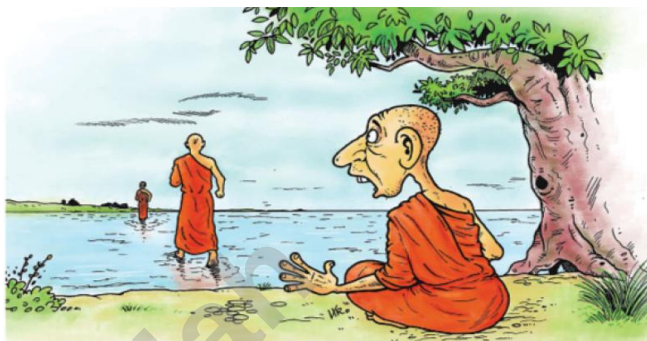
### Walking On Water

Once, three young **monks** sat on the **bank** of a river in **meditation**. The youngest of the monks began to feel **restless** as the ground on which they were sitting was hard.

"I'd be able to concentrate better if I could sit on my prayer **mat**," he thought. He got up and, excusing himself, walked across the river to **fetch** his prayer mat from the **hermitage**.

The senior-most monk saw this. "I can't believe it!" he said, **staring** at the young monk in **disbelief**. "When did he learn to walk on water?"

Just then, the other monk got up with a start. "Oh, no! I've left my laundry in the bucket! If I don't hang them up to dry, I **shan't** have dry clothes to change into!" And he too ran across the river to the hermitage.



"He can walk on water too!" said the **astonished** senior-most monk. "I've been a monk here for so many years but I've never walked on water. Well, if those two can, surely I should be able to do it too."

He stepped into the river but his feet went right through the water. He would have **drowned** if the other two monks hadn't come to his rescue.

Feeling **humiliated**, he decided to leave the **monastery** and go back to his old way of life. Subsequently, he got married and had children. Then one day, he took his family to see the old monastery.

"Father! Father! Look at that monk walking across the river!" **shouted** his son excitedly.

"Yes, my son, the monks here are able to walk on water."

The little boy was **intrigued**. When the monk reached the bank, he ran to him. "Please will you teach me to walk on water?" he asked.

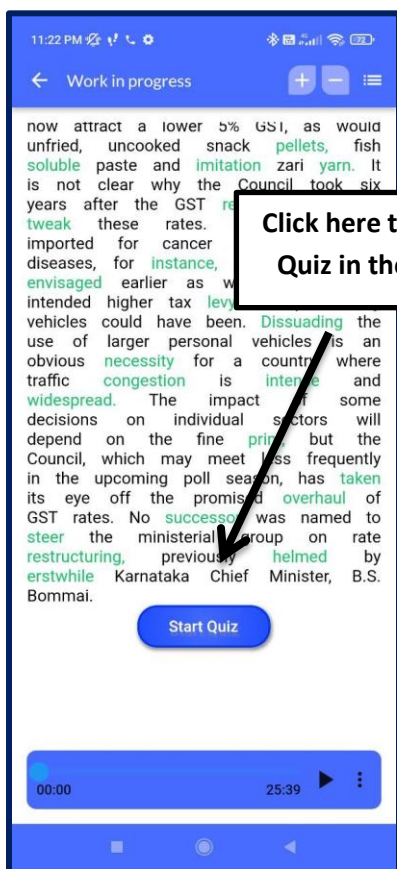
The monk looked **blankly** at the boy for a moment, and then **burst out laughing**. "All right, but make sure you follow my steps carefully!" he said.

The little boy caught hold of the monk's hand with one hand and **grabbed** his **robe** from behind with the other. Then very carefully, he put his leg in the river just as he saw the monk do, and stepping on the pathway of stones below the surface, he walked across to the other side.

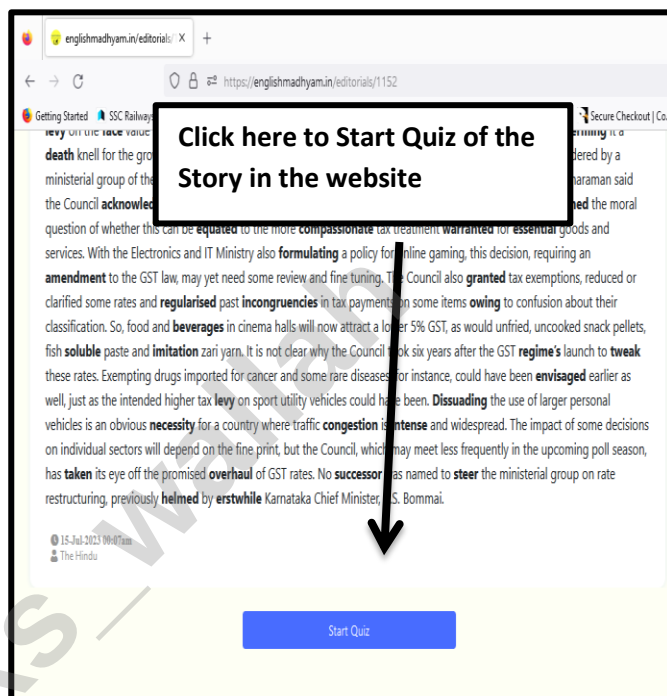
## Vocabulary

1. **Monk** (noun) – ascetic, friar, hermit, mendicant, cloistered devotee साधु / भिक्षु
2. **Bank** (noun) – riverside, edge, shore, embankment, waterfront नदी किनारा
3. **Meditation** (noun) – contemplation, reflection, introspection, concentration, mindfulness ध्यान
4. **Restless** (adjective) – uneasy, agitated, impatient, fidgety, unsettled बेचैन
5. **Mat** (noun) – rug, carpet, pad, floor covering, cushion चटाई
6. **Fetch** (verb) – go and get, retrieve, bring, carry, collect लाना
7. **Hermitage** (noun) – monastery, retreat, ashram, sanctuary, cloister तपोवन / साधु निवास
8. **Stare** (at) (verb) – gaze, gawk, look intently, ogle, goggle घूरना
9. **Disbelief** (noun) – amazement, doubt, astonishment, skepticism, incredulity अविश्वास
10. **Shan't** (modal verb) – shall not, will not, refuse to, decline to, won't नहीं करूँगा
11. **Astonished** (adjective) – amazed, stunned, surprised, astounded, flabbergasted आश्चर्यचकित
12. **Drown** (verb) – sink, submerge, go under, be engulfed, go down डूब जाना
13. **Humiliated** (adjective) – ashamed, embarrassed, disgraced, dishonored, mortified अपमानित
14. **Monastery** (noun) – abbey, hermitage, convent, retreat, religious dwelling मठ
15. **Shout** (verb) – yell, scream, call, exclaim, bellow चिल्लाना
16. **Intrigued** (adjective) – curious, fascinated, interested, engrossed, captivated जिज्ञासु
17. **Blankly** (adverb) – vacantly, expressionlessly, dully, blank-faced, emotionlessly बिना हाव-भाव के
18. **Burst out laughing** (phrase) – laugh suddenly, erupt in laughter, giggle out loud, explode in mirth, crack up जोर से हँस पड़ना
19. **Grab** (verb) – seize, clutch, snatch, hold, grasp पकड़ना
20. **Robe** (noun) – gown, cloak, mantle, drape, vestment चोगा / वस्त्र

## Practice Exercise



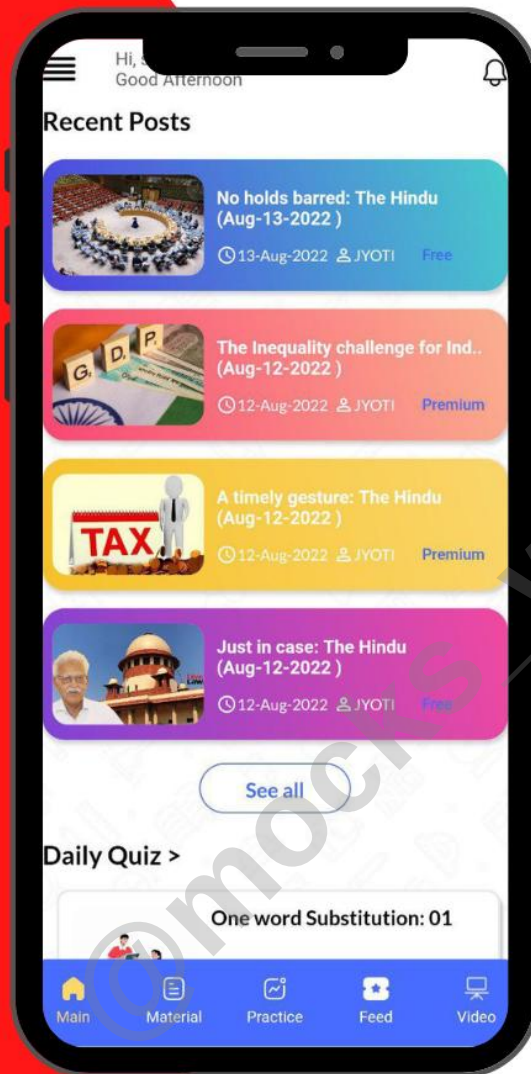
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